

Different outcomes: Manchester City's Erling Haaland, sporting a new hairdo, failed to score in his opening game of a Premier League season for the first time. **Below:** Fermin Lopez scored a quickfire brace to power Barcelona to a 5-0 win over Elche. AFP & AP

have already started ringing after it was completely blown apart by London rival Brentford, which won 3-0, a scoreline that could have gotten worse if not for Igor Thiago's missed effort from the penalty spot.

Liverpool and Manchester City came close to joining that group of upsets but escaped thanks to some late drama. The Reds had to come back from a goal down twice after Anthony Elanga and Joe Willock scored for Newcastle United. But Cody Gakpo struck from long range before Dominik Szoboszlai converted what Newcastle head coach Matthias Jaissle described as 'a soft penalty' deep into stoppage time, helping Liverpool salvage a point.

Meanwhile in Manchester, Enzo Maresca was heading towards a disastrous start to his stint as City manager after Marcus Tavernier put Bournemouth in the lead at the Etihad. But Rayan Cherki came off the bench to assist Marc Guehi and Josko Gvardiol's late goals and save Maresca's blushes.

The fixture also marked the first time star striker Erling Haaland has failed to score in his first game of a Premier League season, and light-hearted theories are already arising about whether he is the modern-day Samson as the Norwegian came onto the pitch sporting a fresh buzzcut look instead of the famed blonde locks.

La Liga

The Spanish league season surprisingly kicked off the first matchday without its two biggest teams, Barcelona and Real Madrid, after they were given extra mandatory rest because some of their players had played deep into the World Cup.

That extended breathing room seemed to work wonders for

